Pushing Forward

An Initiative to Maintain a Skateboarding Program for the Youth of Worcester Massachusetts

Authored by Tyler Nguyen
Written on behalf of Push Worcester
December 15, 2023

Push Worcester

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December 15, 2023

The Skatepark Project
1611 S. Melrose Drive, Suite A #360
Vista, CA 92081

Dear Board of Trustee Members,

I am writing to submit a grant proposal for the maintenance of our community skateboarding programs on behalf of Push Worcester. Push Worcester is a not-for-profit organization that has been serving the Worcester community since its conception in 2018. Our mission is to provide a safe and inclusive environment for youth of all backgrounds to learn, grow, and develop their skateboarding skills while fostering a sense of community and belonging.

Our 6 week-long skateboarding camp will mainly be held at Beaver Brook from June 1st to July 8th, 2024. The camp will provide participants with the opportunity to:

- Receive instruction from experienced skateboarding instructors.
- Practice and improve their skateboarding skills.
- Develop new friendships and connections.
- Learn about skateboarding culture and history.
- Participate in art activities such as painting and board decorating.

We are requesting $50,000 to support the following project activities:

- Creation of a safe and accessible skateboarding facility
- Purchase of skateboarding equipment and supplies
- Compensation for experienced skateboarding instructors
- Provision of water and snacks for campers
- Transportation to and from the camp for participants with limited access to transport

We believe that our skateboarding camp will have a significant positive impact on the youth of our community. Skateboarding is a sport that promotes physical activity, creativity, self-expression, and perseverance. Our camp will provide a unique opportunity for youth to develop these skills and values in a supportive and encouraging environment. We are committed to making our skateboarding camp accessible to all youth, regardless of their financial situation. We are grateful for your consideration of our grant proposal. We are confident that with your support, we can provide a transformative experience for the youth of the Worcester community.

Sincerely,

Tyler Nguyen

Table of Contents

Push Worcester 2
Favorable determination letter 4
1.1 Statement of the Problem 5
1.2 Lack of Access to Positive Activities and Opportunities for Impoverished Youth: 5
1.3 Skateboarding as a Solution 5
1.4 The Need for a Skateboarding Camp for Impoverished Youth 6
2.1 Statement of Request 7
3.1 Description of Proposed Work 7
3.2 Project Objectives 7
3.3 Project Activities 7
3.4 Project Timeline 8
3.5 Project Budget 8
3.6 Expected Outcomes and Evaluation 8
3.7 Sustainability Plan 8
4.1 Measuring Project Success for Push Worcester Skateboarding Camp 9
5.1 Summary 11
5.2 Resolving the Lack of Transportation for the Push Worcester Skateboarding Camp 11
5.3 Addressing the Cost of Equipment for Push Worcester Skateboarding Camp 13
5.4 Addressing the Lack of Safe and Accessible Skate Parks for Beginner Skateboarders 14
5.5 Skateboarding Role Models 16
6.1 Press Clippings 18
7.1 Skatepark Design 20
8.1 Financial Statement 21
Conclusion: Empowering Youth Through Skateboarding with Push Worcester 23
Bibliography 25
Image Credits 26

Favorable determination letter

December 15th, 2023

Push Worcester

Worcester, MA, 01602

Re: Determination Letter Under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code

Dear Members of The Skatepark Project,

The Internal Revenue Service has determined that Push Worcester is exempt from federal income tax under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, effective from [Effective Date]. This means that your organization is considered a charitable organization and is not required to pay federal income tax on its income.

As a tax-exempt organization, Push Worcester is eligible for several benefits, including:

- The ability to receive tax-deductible contributions from individuals and corporations
- The exemption from certain taxes, such as property taxes and sales taxes
- The ability to apply for grants from government agencies and foundations

In addition, Push Worcester is subject to certain requirements, including:

- The filing of an annual Form 990 or 990-EZ with the IRS
- The maintenance of accurate financial records
- The disclosure of certain information to the public

Please refer to Publication 557, Tax-Exempt Status for Organizations, for more information on the benefits and responsibilities of being a tax-exempt organization.

We are pleased to inform you of your organization's tax-exempt status. We encourage you to continue your important work in the community.

Sincerely,

Internal Revenue Service

Determinations Program

1.1 Statement of the Problem

1.2 Lack of Access to Positive Activities and Opportunities for Impoverished Youth:

Impoverished youth often face numerous challenges, including limited access to positive activities, role models, and opportunities. This lack of access can contribute to negative outcomes, such as:

- **Increased risk of delinquency and criminal behavior:** Data from the California Census and Criminal Justice Statistics Center suggests that as poverty rates increase, so does the rate of incarceration.
- **Poor academic performance:** Research shows that poverty can significantly impact academic achievement. A 2019 study by Kendra McKenzie of the Department of Education found that students from low-income families are more likely to score lower on standardized tests and drop out of school.
- **Mental health issues:** Children living in poverty are at an increased risk for depression, anxiety, and other mental health problems.
- **Low household income:** According to data gathered by Census.gov, the city of Worcester's median household income is about $56,746, compared to the state average of about $89,026. In addition to having a considerably lower median income, 19.3% of people living in Worcester are impoverished.

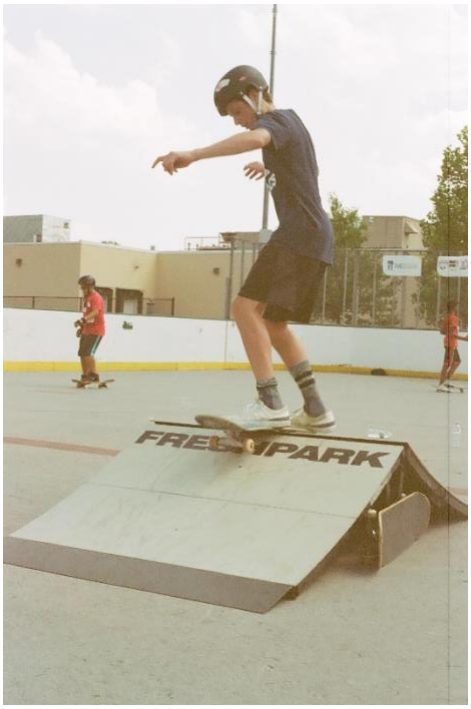


Figure 1 Camper learning to skate a mini ramp -Photo by Tyler Nguyen

1.3 Skateboarding as a Solution

Skateboarding offers a unique opportunity to address these challenges and provide a positive outlet for impoverished youth. Skateboarding is a physically and mentally demanding activity that requires dedication, perseverance, and creativity. It can also be a powerful tool for building confidence, self-esteem, and social skills.

Specifically, skateboarding can help youth in the following ways:

- **Increase physical activity levels**: Skateboarding is a great way to get exercise and improve cardiovascular health, strength, and balance.
- **Develop positive coping mechanisms:** Skateboarding provides a healthy outlet for stress and frustration and can help youth develop coping mechanisms for dealing with difficult situations.

- **Build self-confidence and self-esteem:** Mastering new tricks and challenges on the skateboard can give youth a sense of accomplishment and boost their self-confidence and self-esteem.
- **Promote social interaction and community:** Skate parks and skate spots provide opportunities for youth to connect with other skaters, build friendships, and feel a sense of belonging.
- **Develop life skills:** Skateboarding requires discipline, dedication, and perseverance. These skills are valuable for success in all aspects of life.

1.4 The Need for a Skateboarding Camp for Impoverished Youth

While skateboarding offers numerous benefits for youth, many kids do not have access to the resources and opportunities they need to participate in the sport. This is due to a variety of factors, including:

- **Lack of safe and accessible skate parks:** Many communities, particularly low-income communities, do not have safe and accessible skate parks.
- **Cost of equipment:** Skateboards, safety gear, and other equipment can be expensive, making it difficult for low-income families to afford.
- **Lack of transportation:** Many youths do not have access to reliable transportation to get to skate parks.
- **Lack of positive role models:** Some youth may not have positive role models who are involved in skateboarding.

A skateboarding camp specifically designed for impoverished youth can address these challenges and provide them with the opportunity to experience the benefits of skateboarding.

Such a camp would provide:

- **Access to a safe and supervised environment:** The camp would be held at a safe and inclusive skate park where youth can learn and practice without fear of injury or harassment.
- **Equipment and instruction:** The camp would provide all necessary equipment and instruction from experienced skateboarders.
- **Transportation:** Transportation to and from the camp will be provided for participants.
- **Mentorship and positive role models:** Camp staff would serve as mentors and positive role models for the youth, providing guidance and support.

By addressing the lack of access to positive activities and opportunities for impoverished youth in Worcester, a skateboarding camp can help to improve their physical and mental health, build their life skills, and create a brighter future.

We believe that skateboarding is a powerful tool for positive change, and we are committed to providing this opportunity to as many youths as possible.

2.1 Statement of Request

We are requesting a grant of $50,000 to support our skateboarding camp program. This funding will be used to cover the cost of equipment, the facilities, and the camp instructors.

- **Equipment:** We need to purchase skateboards, helmets, pads, and other safety equipment.
- **Facility:** We need to create a safe and accessible skatepark for our camp and our growing skateboarding community.
- **Instructors:** We need to hire experienced, preferably local, skaters to act as instructors to provide instruction and mentorship to our campers.

We are committed to ensuring the long-term sustainability of our skateboarding camp program.

3.1 Description of Proposed Work

Push Worcester is excited to propose a six-week skateboarding camp for underserved youth. This camp will provide a safe and inclusive environment where youth can learn new skills, build confidence, and develop positive relationships. Through skateboarding, we aim to empower youth to overcome challenges, reach their full potential, and become positive contributors to their communities.

3.2 Project Objectives

- Increase physical activity levels among participating youth.
- Improve participants' self-esteem and overall mental well-being.
- Enhance participants' social skills and ability to build positive relationships.
- Reduce participants' risk of engaging in risky behaviors.
- Increase participants' knowledge and appreciation for skateboarding culture.
- Harbor a sense of community among campers and local skateboarders.

3.3 Project Activities

Daily skateboarding instruction led by experienced and volunteer instructors. Group workshops on topics such as teamwork, goal setting, and conflict resolution. Mentorship opportunities with positive role models in the skateboarding community. Field trips to local skate parks and competitions. Skate art workshops and other creative activities. Water and snacks are provided daily.

3.4 Project Timeline

Pre-camp: March 1st - April 30th (Recruitment, registration, instructor training, facility booking)

Camp Duration: June 1st - July 8th (Six weeks, Monday-Friday, 9:00 AM - 4:00 PM)

Post-camp: July 15th - August 31st (Evaluation, data analysis, reporting)

3.5 Project Budget

Total: $50,000
Skatepark: $30,500
Personnel: $10,080 (Skateboarding instructors, mentors)
Equipment: $4,260 (Skateboards, helmets, pads, safety gear)
Transportation: $2,000
Water and Snacks: $1,140
Contingency: $2,020
Details regarding expenses can be found in section 7.1 Financial Statement.

3.6 Expected Outcomes and Evaluation

- Pre- and post-camp surveys to measure changes in physical activity levels, self-esteem, and social skills.
- Attendance and participation records.
- Qualitative feedback from participants and instructors.
- Documentation of success stories and positive outcomes.

3.7 Sustainability Plan

- Develop strong partnerships with local businesses and organizations to secure ongoing funding.
- Organize fundraising events and grant writing campaigns.
- Develop a tiered fee structure to incentivize participation and generate income.
- Implement volunteer opportunities to engage the community and reduce operational costs.

Push Worcester's non-profit skateboarding camp aims to empower underserved youth through skateboarding. To ensure our program's effectiveness and maximize its positive impact, we will track and measure success across various domains. This document outlines our key performance indicators (KPIs) and evaluation methods.

4.1 Measuring Project Success for Push Worcester Skateboarding Camp

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

1. Physical Activity Levels:

- **Measurement:** Pre- and post-camp surveys assessing physical activity frequency, duration, and intensity.
- **Target:** Increase in self-reported physical activity levels by 20% from pre- to post-camp.
- **Success:** Achieving or exceeding the target increase in physical activity levels.

2. Mental Well-being:

- **Measurement:** Pre- and post-camp surveys assessing self-esteem, anxiety, and depression levels.
- **Target:** Improvement in self-esteem and reductions in anxiety and depression scores.
- **Success:** Demonstrating statistically significant improvements in mental health measures.

3. Social Skills and Relationships:

- **Measurement:** Direct observation of participant interactions, peer assessments, and self-reported surveys on social skills.
- **Target:** Increased positive social interactions, improved communication skills, and stronger peer relationships.
- **Success:** Observing consistent improvements in social behaviors and relationships among participants.

4. Reduced Risk of Risky Behaviors:

- **Measurement:** Pre- and post-camp surveys assessing attitudes and intentions toward risky behaviors.
- **Target:** Decrease in self-reported risk-taking behaviors and negative peer influences.
- **Success:** Demonstrating a positive shift in attitudes and intentions related to risky behaviors.

5. Knowledge and Appreciation for Skateboarding:

- **Measurement:** Pre- and post-camp quizzes on skateboarding history, culture, and safety practices.

- **Target:** Increase skateboarding knowledge and appreciation for the sport and its community.
- **Success:** Demonstrating significant improvements in skateboarding knowledge and appreciation.

6. Participant Satisfaction and Engagement:

- **Measurement:** Post-camp surveys on overall satisfaction, program elements, and areas for improvement.
- **Target:** High participant satisfaction and engagement levels with the program.
- **Success:** Achieving an average satisfaction score of 4 or higher (on a scale of 1-5) and high attendance rates.

7. Community Impact:

- **Measurement:** Number of volunteers engaged, partnerships established, and community events organized.
- **Target:** Fostering positive community engagement and promoting skateboarding as a valuable social activity.
- **Success:** Demonstrating a growing network of supporters and active participation in community-based initiatives.

Evaluation Methods:

- **Quantitative Data:** Pre- and post-camp surveys, attendance records, and performance assessments.
- **Qualitative Data:** Focus group discussions, individual interviews, and observation notes.
- **Data Analysis:** Statistical analysis of quantitative data and thematic analysis of qualitative data.

Reporting:

- **Progress reports:** Regularly updated reports to stakeholders on program progress and key findings.
- **Final report:** Comprehensive report summarizing program results, achievements, and recommendations for future improvement.

Conclusion:

By implementing a comprehensive evaluation plan and tracking key performance indicators, Push Worcester can effectively assess the impact of the skateboarding camp program. This data

will enable us to continuously improve our program, ensure its long-term sustainability, and demonstrate positive outcomes for our participants and the community.

Additional Considerations:

Tracking the progress of program participants over time to measure sustained impact.

- **Qualitative feedback:** Gathering feedback from participants, parents, and instructors to gain deeper insights into program effectiveness.
- **Benchmarking:** Comparing program results with other similar skateboarding initiatives to identify best practices.

By incorporating these evaluation methods and considerations, Push Worcester can ensure the success of its skateboarding camp program and maximize its positive impact on the lives of underserved youth.

5.1 Summary

5.2 Resolving the Lack of Transportation for the Push Worcester Skateboarding Camp

Transportation is a significant barrier for many low-income youths, especially when it comes to participating in extracurricular activities like Push Worcester's skateboarding camp. To address this challenge and ensure equitable access for all, the camp can implement various strategies:

1. Partnerships:

- Collaborate with local transportation authorities like the Worcester Regional Transit Authority (WRTA) to offer discounted passes or dedicated shuttle services for camp participants.
- Partner with ridesharing companies like Uber or Lyft to provide subsidized transportation options.
- Build partnerships with local businesses like bicycle shops such as the Worcester Earn-a-Bike, Inc., to offer discounted rentals for participants.

2. Volunteer Network:

- Establish a volunteer network of parents, community members, and older youth to provide transportation assistance.
- Implement a carpooling system to connect participants living in the same areas.
- Recruit volunteers with vans or larger vehicles to accommodate multiple participants.

3. Camp Modifications:

- Consider offering smaller, satellite camp locations spread across different neighborhoods in Worcester to reduce travel distances.
- Explore the possibility of providing transportation to and from pick-up and drop-off points within each neighborhood.
- Offer flexible scheduling options, including half-day sessions or staggered start times, to accommodate participants with limited transportation options.

4. Alternative Activities:

- Organize mobile skate sessions in different neighborhoods to bring the camp experience directly to participants.
- Partner with local skateparks to offer free or discounted open skate sessions for camp participants.
- Provide online resources and tutorials to encourage participants to continue practicing skateboarding outside of camp hours.

5. Fundraising and Advocacy:

- Secure grants and donations to support transportation initiatives.
- Advocate for improved public transportation options in underserved communities.
- Raise awareness about the transportation challenges faced by low-income youth and the importance of addressing them.

Additional Considerations:

- Implement a system for tracking and evaluating the effectiveness of different transportation solutions.
- Gather feedback from participants and their families to identify their specific needs and preferences.
- Ensure all transportation options are safe, reliable, and accessible for participants with disabilities.

By implementing a combination of these strategies, Push Worcester can effectively address transportation barriers and ensure that all low-income youth have the opportunity to participate in the camp and experience the many benefits skateboarding offers.

5.3 Addressing the Cost of Equipment for Push Worcester Skateboarding Camp

One of the major barriers to entry for skateboarding is the cost of equipment. Push Worcester recognizes this challenge and has developed several strategies to ensure that all youth, regardless of their financial background, have access to the equipment they need to participate in the camp.

1. Donations and Sponsorships:

- Partner with local businesses, organizations, and individuals to collect donations of new and gently used skateboards, helmets, pads, and other equipment.
- Secure sponsorships from skateboarding brands and retailers to receive discounted equipment or in-kind donations.
- Organize fundraising events, such as skate jams or raffles, to raise funds for purchasing equipment.

2. Equipment Sharing and Loan Programs:

- Implement a system for sharing equipment among participants, allowing them to borrow boards, helmets, and pads during camp sessions.
- Partner with local skate shops to offer discounted equipment rentals or lease programs for camp participants.
- Organize equipment swap days where participants can exchange outgrown or unwanted equipment for different sizes or styles.

3. Grants and Funding:

- Apply for grants from foundations and organizations that support youth development and physical activity programs.
- Utilize grant funding to purchase new equipment or partner with equipment manufacturers to receive bulk discounts.
- Allocate a portion of the camp budget specifically toward equipment acquisition and maintenance.

5. Maintenance and Repair:

- Organize workshops and training sessions to teach participants basic skateboarding maintenance and repair skills.
- Provide participants with access to tools and resources for maintaining their equipment.
- Partner with local skate shops or bike repair shops to offer discounted equipment repair services to camp participants.

6. Long-Term Sustainability:

- Develop partnerships with equipment manufacturers or distributors to establish long-term supply agreements at discounted rates.
- Implement a fundraising plan to secure sustainable funding for equipment acquisition and maintenance.
- Explore opportunities to create a social enterprise program that sells or rents skateboards to generate income for future equipment needs.

By implementing these strategies, Push Worcester can ensure that the cost of equipment is not a barrier to participation in the skateboarding camp. This commitment to accessibility will allow us to empower youth from all backgrounds and contribute to a more inclusive and vibrant skateboarding community in Worcester.

5.4 Addressing the Lack of Safe and Accessible Skate Parks for Beginner Skateboarders

The limited availability of safe and accessible skate parks can significantly hinder beginner skaters' progress and enjoyment. To address this challenge, various solutions can be implemented:

1. Expanding Existing Skate Parks:

- Advocate for the expansion of existing skate parks to include dedicated areas for beginner skaters.
- Install features like ramps, rails, and ledges at varying heights and slopes to accommodate different skill levels.
- Designate specific times for beginner-only sessions to create a safer and less intimidating environment.

2. Creating Pop-Up Skate Parks:

- Utilize temporary structures and equipment to create pop-up skate parks in underutilized spaces like parking lots or empty fields.
- Partner with local businesses and organizations to host pop-up skate events in their parking lots or open spaces.
- Collaborate with community centers and schools to offer temporary skate park installations on their premises.

3. Utilizing Alternative Spaces:

- Identify and repurpose existing structures like abandoned buildings or parking garages into temporary skate parks.
- Partner with businesses like skate shops to offer designated areas for beginner skaters within their facilities.
- Explore the use of mobile skate parks that can be transported and set up in various locations.

4. Community Engagement and Partnerships:

- Organize workshops and events to educate the community about the benefits of skateboarding and the need for safe spaces.
- Partner with community leaders, businesses, and organizations to secure funding and support for skate park development.
- Engage local youth in the design and planning process to ensure the skate park meets their needs and preferences.

5. Advocacy and Awareness:

- Advocate for changes in zoning regulations and policies to facilitate the development of skate parks.
- Partner with organizations like local skate shops or established skate brands to leverage their resources and expertise.
- Raise public awareness about the importance of safe and accessible skate parks for promoting physical activity, mental well-being, and community development.

Additional Considerations:

- Ensure all skate parks are designed and constructed according to safety standards and guidelines.
- Provide adequate lighting, security, and first-aid facilities at all skate parks.
- Offer free or low-cost lessons and workshops for beginner skaters to encourage participation.
- Develop a maintenance plan to ensure that skate parks remain safe and usable for all.

By implementing these solutions and fostering collaboration among various stakeholders, communities can create a more inclusive skateboarding environment where beginners feel safe, welcome, and empowered to progress in their skateboarding journey.

5.5 Skateboarding Role Models

Low-income communities often face a lack of positive role models for youth, which can negatively impact their development and aspirations. Skating camps can play a crucial role in addressing this issue by providing access to positive mentors and role models who can inspire, guide, and support young people.

Here's how skateboarding camps can address the lack of positive role models:

1. Providing Mentorship:

- Recruit experienced skateboarders, community leaders, and positive individuals to serve as mentors and instructors at the camp.
- Create a structured mentorship program where youth can build close relationships with their mentors and receive guidance on personal and social development.
- Organize workshops and discussions on topics such as goal setting, decision-making, and overcoming challenges.
- Encourage mentors to share their personal stories and experiences to inspire and motivate youth.

2. Building Positive Peer Relationships:

- Create a safe and inclusive environment where youth can feel comfortable and accepted.
- Encourage teamwork, cooperation, and mutual support among participants.
- Organize activities and events that promote social skills development and positive peer relationships.
- Celebrate individual and team achievements to foster a sense of belonging and community.

3. Exposing Youth to Diverse Role Models:

- Invite professional skateboarders, entrepreneurs, artists, and other successful individuals from diverse backgrounds to interact with the campers.
- Organize field trips to businesses, organizations, and events that showcase positive role models and career paths.
- Encourage campers to research and learn about inspirational figures they admire.
- Provide opportunities for campers to meet and interact with successful individuals from their communities.

4. Promoting Positive Values:

- Integrate life skills, values education, and character development into the camp curriculum.
- Encourage behaviors such as respect, responsibility, perseverance, and sportsmanship.
- Foster a positive learning environment where mistakes are seen as opportunities for growth.
- Use skateboarding as a tool to teach valuable life lessons about resilience, overcoming obstacles, and achieving goals.

5. Building Leadership Skills:

- Provide opportunities for older or experienced campers to mentor younger participants.
- Encourage campers to take on leadership roles in organizing activities and events.
- Offer leadership workshops and training to equip youth with the skills and confidence to lead and inspire others.

6. Strengthening Community Links:

- Partner with local schools, community centers, and organizations to connect youth with additional resources and support services.
- Organize community events and outreach programs to engage families and promote positive social change.
- Collaborate with local businesses to provide internship and employment opportunities for campers.

Figure 2 Local volunteers taking a break at camp – Photo by Tyler Nguyen

By implementing these strategies, skateboarding camps can become powerful tools for addressing the lack of positive role models in low-income communities. By providing access to mentors, promoting positive values, and fostering strong community connections, these camps can empower youth to reach their full potential and become positive contributors to society.

6.1 Press Clippings

LOCAL

'You are your own brakes': Skate camp starts for Worcester Community Skateshop

Bill Shaner

Published 12:15 p.m. ET July 17, 2019

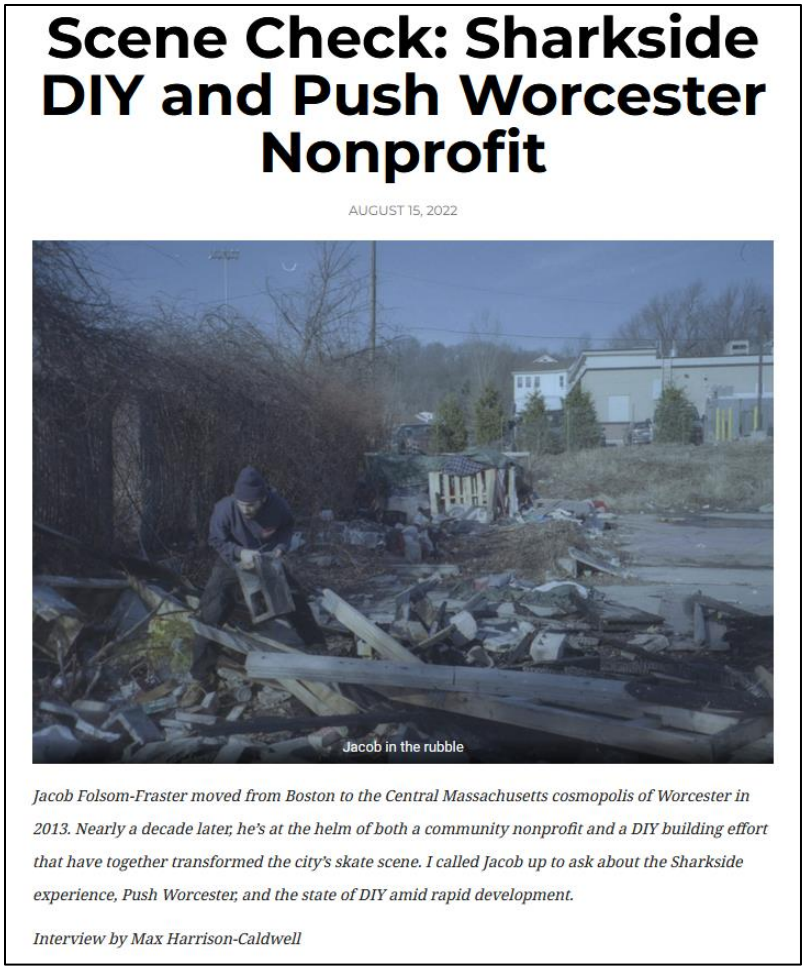
Leila Harrigan, 8, and instructor Marika Thompson take a break during the Worcester Skate Collaborative summer camp at Beaver Brook Park on Tuesday, July 16, 2019. *Worcester Magazine*

Jacob Folsom-Fraster stood on the spine of a short, portable ramp in the middle of the Beaver Brook street hockey rink. He was surrounded by a small handful of volunteers and 25 or so kids, most newly outfitted in helmets, wrist guards and boards. They ranged from 8 years old to early teens.

"Welcome to skate camp," he said. Over the next four weeks, Folsom-Fraster and

Figure 3 Press clipping of an article from a local magazine.
https://www.worcestermag.com/story/entertainment/local/2019/07/17/you-are-your-own-brakes-skate-camp-starts-for-worcester-community-skateshop/4665826007/

In 2019, when Push Worcester was called the Worcester Community Skateshop, the local magazine covered the beginning of Worcester's first camp dedicated to skateboarding. Jacob Folsom-Fraster, the founder of Push Worcester, gives an overview of the skate camp and its mission. This exposure proves that there is a need for a skate camp in Worcester. There is a clear lack of affordable skateboards in Worcester and this camp provides access to the equipment, as well as a space to participate. In collaboration with YouthWorks, a youth employment program, this camp also provides young adults with paid opportunities that provide them with work experience and a means of connecting with the community.



Scene Check: Sharkside DIY and Push Worcester Nonprofit

AUGUST 15, 2022

Jacob in the rubble

Jacob Folsom-Fraster moved from Boston to the Central Massachusetts cosmopolis of Worcester in 2013. Nearly a decade later, he's at the helm of both a community nonprofit and a DIY building effort that have together transformed the city's skate scene. I called Jacob up to ask about the Sharkside experience, Push Worcester, and the state of DIY amid rapid development.

Interview by Max Harrison-Caldwell

Figure 4 Skate Jawn magazine article on Push Worcester. https://skatejawn.com/scene-check-sharkside-diy-and-push-worcester/

Fast forward to 2022. Jacob is interviewed regarding a DIY skatepark called "Sharkside" and his newly named organization—Push Worcester. In the article, Jacob explains the importance of grassroots DIY skateparks and the community that surrounds them. At this point, the summer skate camp is halted for unforeseen reasons. In its stead, there are infrequent skateboarding events such as the "Escape Winter Pop-up Skate Plaza" and various skateboarding-themed art events. With the funds from this grant, we can create and bring back the skate camp for all youths of Worcester to enjoy.

7.1 Skatepark Design

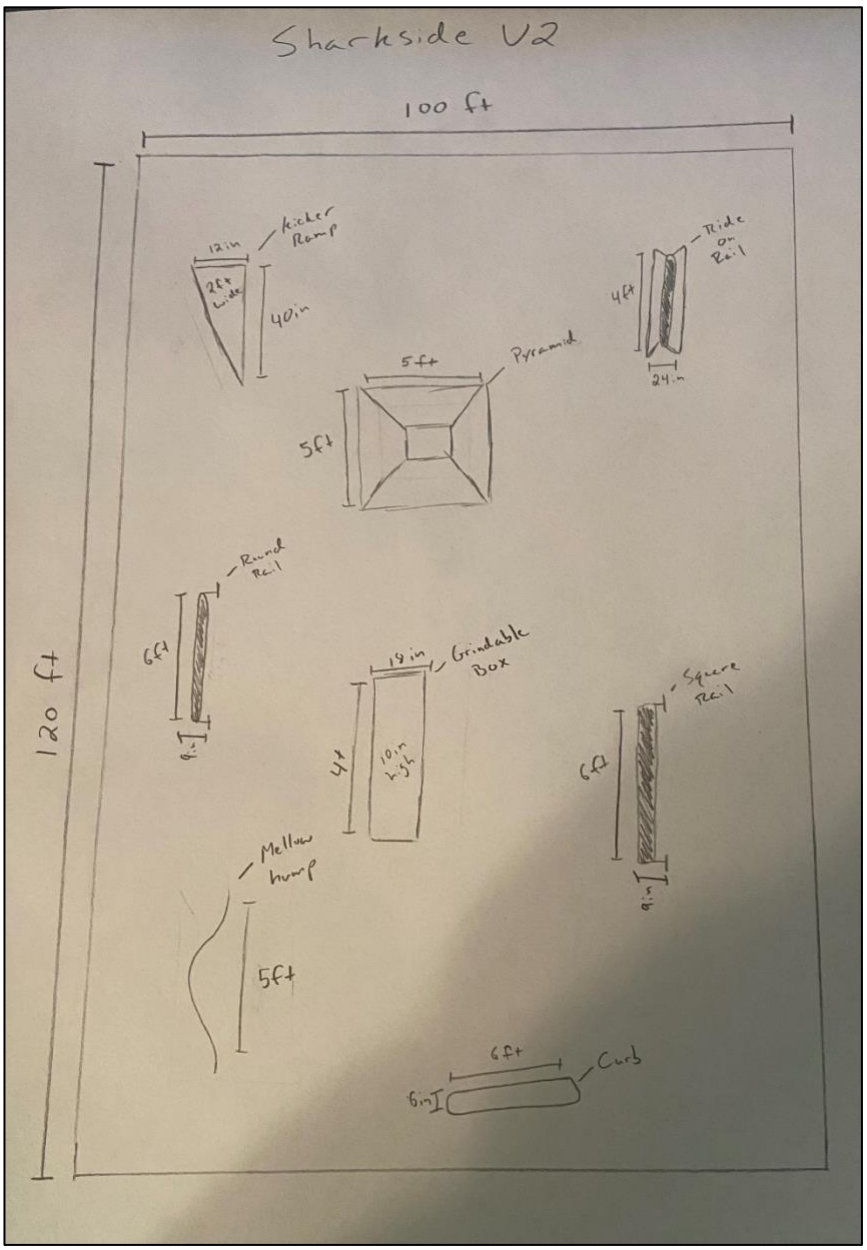


Figure 5 A simple skatepark design paying homage to the DIY skatepark.

The goal of this skatepark is to have a variety of small obstacles that are accessible to beginners. The features of the skatepark are placed strategically to ensure that there isn't crowding and there is still room for campers to roll around. Except for the kicker ramp, none of the obstacles are higher than 11 inches. This makes for easy access while ensuring that there is nothing too big that will risk injury to new skateboarders. The various obstacles allow the campers to progress while learning a variety of tricks and skills. Within the Worcester skate community, many skilled individuals can help overcome these obstacles. Because the obstacles in this skatepark are smaller and simpler, we should not have any issues regarding budget or labor.

8.1 Financial Statement

Category	Description	Estimated Cost	Total
Skatepark	Beginner skatepark obstacles and construction	$30,500	$15,000
Personnel	Salaries for experienced skateboarding instructors and organizers	$10,080	$35,000
Equipment	Skateboards, helmets, pads, safety gear	$4,260	$25,000
Water and Snacks	Water and snacks for campers	$1,140	$40,000
Transportation	Transportation costs for participants	$2,000	$42,000
Contingency	Unforeseen expenses	$2,020	$50,000

Creating a space for the camp is of the utmost importance for this project and most of the grant funds will be allocated to a skatepark made up of beginner obstacles. Building a skatepark is an incredibly expensive endeavor and we will need to rely on help from the DIY community in Worcester. We originally considered using the "Public Skatepark Development Guide" to calculate the materials for the skatepark. However, that would have forced us into a smaller space, about 1,200 square feet, and with little room to consider materials. With this proposed budget, we believe that we can construct a 12,500-square-foot beginner skatepark using the vacant lot where the DIY skatepark used to reside. Alternatively, if we are not able to build in that lot, we can try to negotiate with the city to build in the, rarely used, outdoor hockey rink—the location where the original skate camp was held. This calculation is based on a skatepark project that took place in Phoenix, AZ where the city used lottery funds to construct a skate plaza in place of old tennis courts. Their budget was around $20,000, and based on that figure, we believe that this is something that we can achieve if we were to work with the city.

Estimated Cost of Skatepark		
Project	Equipment/Materials	Cost
Materials	12,000 square-feet	$2/square-feet = $24,000
Obstacles for the Skatepark	Rails, boxes, ramps, etc.	$6,500
		Total Cost: $30,500

Hiring personnel for the camp is our second priority. In the past, we have relied on the efforts of volunteers and help from organizations in Worcester to pay our instructors. With this proposed budget, we will be paying three main instructors/organizers who will be tasked with overseeing most of the camp's needs. With an hourly rate of $16 X 30 hours a week X 6 weeks, it will cost $10,080 to pay these employees.

Estimated Cost of Personnel		
Project	Working Hours	Cost
Camp Instructors	35 hours	$16/hr.
		Total Cost: $10,080

We will be supplying enough equipment to allow 30 campers to skate at a time. The average cost of a skateboard is about $100 and sets of kneepads and helmets are about $42. This should be enough equipment for the estimated camper population. However, we will have repurposed skateboard equipment and we will accept donations.

To alleviate the cost and the potential disarray of having to provide food accommodation, we encourage parents to pack lunches for their children. We will be providing various snacks and water to the campers throughout the program. The proposed quantity should be more than enough for the duration of the camp and the extra funds will be set aside for special events such as pizza parties.

Estimated Cost of Water and Snacks		
Project	Provisions	Cost
Providing Provisions for Campers	Water	$5/case X 100 = $500
	Snacks	$28/bulk case X 100 = $2,800
	Special Events	$960
		Total Cost: $4,260

As discussed in section 5.2, we will be relying on partnerships with local organizations and volunteers to provide transportation for the campers. The funds allocated to transportation will cover gas and any necessary expenses to help ensure all campers have the opportunity to participate. Other expenses may include creating pop-up campsites and transporting equipment.

Estimated Cost of Transportation		
Project	Equipment	Cost
Providing Transportation for Campers to and from Camp	Gas	Market Avg./Gallon
	Other	TBD
		Total Cost: $2,000

Last, we have a contingency fund that we have in reserve to cover unforeseen expenses that may occur during the six-week program. Unforeseen expenses may include damaged equipment, skatepark repairs, food, etc.

Contingency Fund		
Project	Working Hours	Cost
Unforeseen Expenses	35 hours	$16/hr.
		Total Cost: $10,080

Notes:

- This budget is a general estimate and actual costs may vary.
- The budget can be adjusted based on the specific needs of the camp and the available funding.

Additional Funding Sources:

- Fundraising events (e.g., skate jam, raffle)
- Corporate sponsorships
- Donations from individuals and organizations

Conclusion: Empowering Youth Through Skateboarding with Push Worcester

Push Worcester's skateboarding camp offers a unique and impactful opportunity to empower underserved youth in Worcester, Massachusetts. We believe that skateboarding is more than just a sport; it's a powerful tool for building confidence, self-esteem, resilience, and a sense of community. Through our six-week summer camp, we provide youth with access to professional instruction, mentorship, and a safe and supportive environment.

Impactful Outcomes:

Our camp offers a range of benefits for participants, including:

- **Increased physical activity levels:** Studies have shown that skateboarding can significantly increase physical activity levels in youth, leading to improved overall health and well-being.
- **Enhanced social skills:** Skateboarding provides opportunities for youth to develop social skills such as communication, teamwork, and conflict resolution.
- **Greater self-confidence and self-esteem:** Mastering skateboarding tricks and overcoming challenges helps youth build confidence and a positive self-image.
- **Reduced risk of risky behaviors:** By providing a positive outlet for energy and promoting healthy lifestyles, skateboarding can help reduce the risk of youth engaging in risky behaviors.

- **Exposure to positive role models:** Experienced skateboarders and volunteers serve as mentors, providing guidance and support to young participants.
- **Development of life skills:** Through skateboarding, youth learn valuable life skills such as perseverance, teamwork, and goal setting.

Addressing Community Needs:

Push Worcester's skateboarding camp directly addresses the needs of underserved youth in Worcester. By providing a safe and inclusive environment for youth to engage in skateboarding, we address the lack of positive role models, safe spaces, and opportunities for physical activity and social interaction. Our camp fosters a sense of community and belonging among participants, connecting them to positive peers and role models.

Sustainable Program:

Push Worcester is committed to ensuring the long-term sustainability of the skateboarding camp program. We are actively seeking funding from grants, corporate sponsorships, and individual donations. We are also exploring partnerships with local businesses and organizations to support our camp. Additionally, we are working to develop a tiered fee structure to incentivize participation and generate income.

Investment in Youth:

Investing in Push Worcester's skateboarding camp is an investment in the future of Worcester's youth. By providing them with the opportunity to learn, grow, and thrive through skateboarding, we are creating a more positive and vibrant community for all. We believe that every young person deserves the chance to reach their full potential, and Push Worcester's skateboarding camp is a powerful tool for achieving this goal.

We invite you to partner with Push Worcester and support our mission to empower underserved youth through skateboarding. Your contribution will make a significant difference in the lives of young people and help us build a stronger, healthier community.

Join us in making Push Worcester's skateboarding camp a reality!

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Figure 1: “Spine Transfer” by Tyler Nguyen
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Figure 4: Photo by Skate Jawn. Accessed via https://skatejawn.com/scene-check-sharkside-diy-and-push-worcester/
Figure 5: Skatepark Design by Tyler Nguyen